ORECCHIETTE

REGION	REST
Mostly Puglia; also Calabria, Basilicata, Molise, reaching north into Abruzzo	**1 to 2 hours at room temperature**

METHOD

1. Make semolina dough. Dust a wooden board with a little 00 flour. Line a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
2. Quarter the dough. Work one piece and keep the rest under plastic wrap or a towel.
3. Press the piece into a thick rope by hand. Set the fingertips of both hands together at its midpoint, then roll back and forth while walking your hands apart toward the ends.
4. Keep rolling under light pressure until the rope is about 1/2 inch across, roughly as thick as a Sharpie, and about 18 inches long. Cut it in half and roll the halves separately if it gets too long to handle.
5. Cut the rope into 1/2-inch lengths with a knife or bench scraper. Cut them longer while you are learning, since bigger pieces are easier to shape. Cover the pieces you are not shaping.
6. Hold a butter knife serrated-edge-down with its tip against the edge of a piece at a 30-degree angle, then drag the dough toward you across the board. Lean into it. Semolina dough takes real pressure, and you want the middle of the shape thin. Stopping here gives you a cavatello.
7. Use your first two fingers to pull the dough off the knife and up over your thumb, turning it inside out while your thumb pushes up to form a dome. Work through the rest of the cut pieces.
8. Lay the finished pasta on the sheet pan in a single layer.
9. Repeat from step 3 with the remaining dough.
10. Dry 1 to 2 hours at room temperature, until the pasta stiffens slightly and holds its shape when handled.
11. To hold it, wrap the pan in plastic and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

SHAPING



1 2 3 4

NOTES

Dimensions run 1/2-inch rope, about 18 inches long, cut into 1/2-inch pieces. Finished size ranges from a quarter down to a dime, smallest around Bari.
The tool is the serrated edge of an ordinary butter knife. There are two gestures: the drag, then the flip off the knife tip onto the thumb. The flip is what makes an orecchietta instead of a cavatello, and it is the hardest gesture in the book to get right. Expect hundreds of edible failures first.
Keep the board only lightly floured. Too much flour kills the friction and the drag will not take.
Traditionally a water dough built on semolina, durum wheat flour, grano arso, or a blend of two of the three.
Refrigerator limit is 24 hours.
Sauced with tomato and ricotta salata, or with broccoli rabe cooked down with garlic and anchovy.

DOUGH

Semolina Dough

Makes: 750 g / Active Time: 10-15 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

325 g	Tipo 00 flour
175 g	Semolina flour
250 g	Lukewarm water

up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Stir the two flours together thoroughly, then mound on a wooden surface with a well 5 to 6 inches across.
2. Add the water slowly. Water has no body of its own, so it escapes far more easily than yolks do.
3. Draw in flour from the inner wall with a fork as you pour, working round the circumference until all the water is in.
4. Knead 10 to 15 minutes, pressing down and away, rotating, folding.
5. Add water by the tablespoon only if it stays dry.
6. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes.

NOTES

> Eggless, so it stays more elastic and less tender than egg dough. Do not expect the Play-Doh feel here.
> 50% hydration against 500 g total flour.
> 65% of the flour is 00 and 35% semolina.
> Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

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